NEO GEO POCKET COLOR

GHOSTS 'N GOBLINS

A PORTAL TOO FAR



INSTRUCTION MANUAL

JAJABINX35

A PORTAL TOO FAR / FIELD GUIDE

Two worlds. One knight.

The princess. The portal. The underpants.

Prin Prin has been kidnapped again. Arthur knows the drill: armour on, lance ready, straight into the graveyard. But this time an unexpected visitor has a very different rescue mission for him.

Play the original route, or accept Karin's invitation to a brighter SNK world. The stages keep their familiar layouts. The cast, colours and story have a few surprises in store.

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Take control

Two buttons. Plenty of trouble.

LEFT / RIGHT	Walk and face the direction you want to attack.
DOWN	Crouch. Duck beneath attacks that clear your lowered body.
UP / DOWN	Climb a ladder when aligned with it. Up also lets you look higher where the camera allows.
A	Throw your equipped weapon. Support guests use their own signature attacks.
B	Jump. Press A in the air to attack while jumping.
OPTION	Pause during play. Resume with B or Option, or select RESUME.
A / D-PAD	In menus: move the cursor with the stick and confirm with A. B goes back.

Dialogue: A reveals the rest of the page; press A again to read on. The A:NEXT prompt sits below the sentence. Option skips the boot conversation. In later story scenes, follow the displayed prompt.

Stay in one piece

Armour is useful. Timing is better.



Top of the screen: points (or LOCKED), weapon icon, lives and time. During support play, the guest's name and remaining seconds appear below the usual display.

A hit strips Arthur's armour. Another hit while he is in his underpants costs a life. A fall or an expired timer can end the attempt too. Brief flashing after a safe return gives you time to move.

Use low attacks carefully, watch where enemies emerge, and line up with ladders before climbing. Defeat the stage guardian, collect the key and head onwards. If a support guest is active when the key appears, control returns to Arthur automatically.

Tools of the trade

Know what you are throwing.



TORCH

An arcing throw that falls and burns. Judge the distance.



LANCE

A dependable straight throw. Make room before firing.



AXE

A curved flight path. Time the arc to meet your target.



CRUCIFIX

The late-game holy weapon. Keep it for the foes that demand it.



DAGGER

Fast, straight shots. Useful when a small opening appears.

WATCH FOR PICKUPS

Pots can carry rewards. Treasure adds points; armour restores protection. A weapon pickup replaces the equipped weapon. The key clears the stage after its guardian is defeated. In stage six, the crucifix reward follows the dragon's defeat.

A choice of worlds

One invitation changes the journey.

THE CLASSIC ROUTE

New games begin with the original graphics. Finish stage one to meet Karin at the portal. Choose **NO** to hear her verdict and continue to stage two in the classic world.

ACCEPT THE INVITATION

Choose **YES** and Arthur steps through the portal. Stage one restarts with SNK sprites and coloured scenery, without repeating the kidnapping. The SNK artwork then stays with you through the rest of the journey.

A SECOND CHANCE

If a classic run ends in stage one before you were offered the portal, Karin can offer that trip there instead. Gameplay cheats must be off. Accepting starts the SNK adventure again with your chosen starting allowance.

STORY TIP

The SNK route has its own extended ending. It also plays when SNK SPRITES is enabled in the cheat menu. Classic mode keeps its classic ending. In the crossover fight, A throws Arthur's weapon and B jumps; the fight waits for your hit.

Lives, points & pride

Choose your challenge before setting out.

STARTING ALLOWANCE

The defaults are **3 lives and 3 continues**. Options let you choose 1-9 of each. Continues never go below 1. Starting with 1-3 lives **and** 1-3 continues keeps scores eligible, provided no other unranked setting is used.

EARNED LIVES STILL COUNT

Starting with 4 or more lives or continues locks ranked scores. Earning an extra life during an eligible run does not lock it - reaching 4 lives through play is fine.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU LOSE?

After a life is lost, points roll back to the value saved at the current respawn checkpoint. Using an allowed continue restarts the stage with its entry score. It does not lock a run started within the ranked limits.

Example: enter a stage with 1,000 points, then reach a checkpoint with 1,600. Lose a life and return to 1,600; use a continue to restart that stage and return to 1,000.

LOCKED means the run cannot enter ranked records. Free Save, Easy Mode, gameplay cheats, manual stage restart and stage skipping make a run unranked. Once locked, turning a setting off does not restore eligibility.

Put the quest on hold

RANK mode: save, quit, resume once.

SAVE AN ELIGIBLE RUN

1 / PAUSE Press Option during normal play.

2 / SAVE Select SAVE & QUIT, then press A. Wait until saving finishes and the title returns.

3 / RESUME At the title, choose CONTINUE. The saved game is restored and that one-use save is claimed.

A RANK save lets you stop and return later. Loading claims that one-use save. Make a new save when you want to stop again; RANK has no pause-menu rewind.

AUTOMATIC CHECKPOINTS

Progress is also saved at stage boundaries and story transitions. MAIN MENU saves before returning to the title. CONTINUE appears for an unclaimed valid save.

KEEP YOUR PROGRESS

Wait for save completion before quitting. Keep your emulator cartridge-save data when moving devices. Emulator save states are separate.

Practise without pressure

FREE mode: save and load repeatedly.

ENABLE FREE SAVE

At the title, choose **OPTIONS**, select **SAVE MODE**, then switch RANK to **FREE**. Press B to save the setting and return. Free Save is unranked.

USE THE PAUSE MENU

SAVE GAME Writes progress and keeps the pause menu open. Wait for UNRANKED SAVE OK.

LOAD GAME Restores your stored game. You can return to the same save more than once.

CONTINUE The title-screen CONTINUE can also restore a Free Save. It remains reusable.

KARIN CAN OFFER IT TOO

After you accept her Easy Mode offer and replenish your continues, the next ordinary lost continue brings a separate Free Save offer. Choose Yes to enable it for that run; No keeps normal saving. This offer is not shown when Free Save is already enabled.

Start afresh: OPTIONS > ERASE GAME SAVE removes the stored game after confirmation. Records have their own reset command in the RECORDS screen.

A little help from friends

Karin has noticed the person holding the controls.

In an SNK run with gameplay cheats off, Karin offers Easy Mode when you are down to your **last continue**. Say Yes to refill continues to your starting allowance and lock scores. The current restart still uses the normal spawn point.



RYU



KEN



CHUN LI



AKUMA



MORRIGAN



TERRY



KYO



IORI



MAI



ATHENA

From then on, each eligible death has a **50% chance** of help. Unused guests are favoured over recently seen ones. Sometimes Arthur still loses the life normally.

Akuma can revive Arthur with a white flash. Other guests enter through a portal for ten seconds of invincible support play. Use Arthur's controls, ladders and aerial attacks; each fighter has their own move. Their theme plays during the visit.

Guests leave through a portal. Arthur returns with brief protection; dangerous falls use a safe return point. A stage key ends the guest turn immediately so Arthur can collect it. Combat assists are disabled in the final stage.

Options & secret training

Choose the rules. Then keep your promise.

OPTIONS

LIVES / CONTINUES: 1-9 of each; score eligibility is shown.
PLAYERS: one or two, taking turns.
SOUND: music and effects on/off.
SAVE MODE: RANK or FREE.
ERASE GAME SAVE: clears saved game progress.

UNLOCK CHEAT OPTIONS

On the title, rotate the stick clockwise **ten full circles**: Up, Right, Down, Left, repeating. When CHEATS UNLOCKED appears, open OPTIONS > CHEAT OPTIONS.

INVULNERABLE	Ignore ordinary enemy damage.
INFINITE LIFE	Keep lives when an ordinary life would be lost.
START STAGE	Choose the stage for a new game.
SNK SPRITES	Begin with the SNK art route enabled and bypass the invitation.

Practice runs: using gameplay cheats locks scores and suppresses Karin's help offers. Unlocking the menu alone keeps normal rules. The pause menu gains SKIP STAGE; using it locks scores. The SNK ending still plays in a cheated SNK run.

Until next time, Arthur

Keep the armour. Remember the flowers.

CREDITS

NGPC port: JAJABINX35
Original game: Capcom / Elite
Original programming: R. Frankish
Original artwork: Dave Percival
Original music / sound: M. Cooksey
Amiga disassembly: MarkyTurtle
Crossover characters, art & music: SNK / Capcom
ngpc-dev.com QR code management: Hardhatwarrior

QUICK REFERENCE

A: throw / confirm / read on. **B:** jump / back.
Option: pause. **Up / Down:** ladders.
RANK: one-use resume. **FREE:** repeatable saves.
Story route: accept Karin after stage one.
Records: choose a score and press A for its QR code.



THANKS FOR PLAYING!

M50 fan-project guide / Case artwork concept / October 2026